



STATE OF LOUISIANA
NOPD 9th District



INCIDENT REPORT

CASE NUMBER
D00275914

FILER NAME
Fred Blake

DATE/TIME 1/30, 5:35 PM	INCIDENT TYPE Vandalism	RESPONDING OFFICER(S) Fred Blake	ACTION TAKEN Report, Investigation ongoing
RELATED INCIDENT SUMMARY No related incidents reported		ASSOCIATED BUSINESS INFO No associated businesses reported	

INCIDENT SUMMARY

NOPD 9th District received a call on January 30 at 9:41 AM concerning a break-in at the Mystic Krewe of Marie Laveau den in the Bywater. Reporting officer arrived on the scene at 11:18 AM.

The Bywater warehouse contained costumes, floats, and other krewe property. Seven parade floats were damaged as a result of the break-in. Paint was sprayed all along the floor and across three of the damaged floats. Officer collected security camera footage, took several photographs of the warehouse and surrounding areas, and took a statement from the Mystic Krewe of Marie Laveau captain, Celestine Broussard.

When interviewed, Ms. Broussard stated that she left the den on January 29th at 10:41 PM. After confirming there were no others present and securing all exits, she traveled home by bicycle. Ms. Broussard returned to the den around 9:00 AM on January 30th and found the destruction.

Ms. Broussard directed the responding officer to the security footage. Summary is as follows: at 11:13 PM on January 29th, two individuals entered the den. The first broke a window on the northernmost side and entered, followed by the second. The two walked around the building, checking all entryways, closets, and rooms. The first individual removed their backpack and handed the second a wrench, a paint can, and other tools. Together they began destroying float preparations and equipment stored in the warehouse. At 1:39 AM, they exited via the same window from which they had entered.

Upon viewing the security footage, Ms. Broussard insisted that the individuals appearing on camera were Dillon and Mason Morales. When asked if she knew the Morales brothers personally, she replied that she had known them "since they were kids." When asked to elaborate, she explained that she had taught them visual art in an afterschool program called NOLA KidsArt, and that she had been instrumental in advising them as they founded their own Carnival krewe as young adults. However, the friendship had recently soured. (When asked to explain why, Ms. Broussard responded, "I've got nothing on them you couldn't read in the news.") Ms. Broussard added that tensions increased when Ms. Broussard's organization received the Morales brothers' parade route on Esplanade Avenue after it was reassigned by the city.

The brothers were interviewed at their parents' home in Lakeview, where they currently reside. They insisted they had been at home the entire evening, which their parents corroborated.

The footage was not clear enough to produce definite identification, and no witnesses can confirm Ms. Broussard's claims. It is because of this lack of substantial evidence that I must conclude that the two individuals in the security footage remain at large.

INVESTIGATOR

Fred Blake

DATE

Jan. 30

CASE STATUS:

☐ Further Investigation
☒ Inactive
☐ Closed

FOR INTERNAL USE ONLY